NORTHSTAR
DIGITAL SERVICES

Salary Structure and Compensation Bands

HR ONLY

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Prepared as synthetic content for a role-based retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) demonstration. This document is not an actual company policy.

Access classification: HR ONLY

1. Purpose, classification and governance

Policy owner: HR Operations

Confidentiality classification

HR CONFIDENTIAL — fictional demonstration material. Access is limited to authorized HR personnel with a legitimate business need. Do not distribute to employees or managers through the general policy repository.

Purpose

This document describes a sample framework for job levels, salary bands and compensation governance. All numbers and examples are invented and do not represent any real company or market survey.

Compensation philosophy

Compensation decisions should consider role scope, demonstrated capability, internal equity, relevant market data, location, budget and applicable law. The framework should be explainable, consistently administered and periodically reviewed.

Components

Total compensation may include base salary, variable pay, sign-on awards, benefits and approved allowances. Eligibility and treatment depend on role, contract, jurisdiction and plan documents.

Job architecture

Roles should be evaluated using factors such as complexity, autonomy, impact, required expertise and leadership scope. Titles alone should not determine grade; comparable work should be assessed against the same framework.

Governance

HR Compensation maintains the framework. Finance validates budget impacts; Legal or Compliance reviews relevant legal risks; authorized executives approve material framework changes.

2. Fictional bands and placement principles

Policy owner: HR Operations

Illustrative annual base-pay bands

Example only: Level L1 ■4.0–6.0 lakh; L2 ■6.0–9.0 lakh; L3 ■9.0–14.0 lakh; L4 ■14.0–22.0 lakh; L5 ■22.0–35.0 lakh. These invented ranges are for testing retrieval, not salary guidance.

Band positioning

A salary within a band may reflect proficiency, sustained impact, scarce skills, location and internal equity. A range midpoint is a reference point, not an automatic entitlement or a promise of future increases.

New-hire placement

HR should review the approved role level, relevant experience, skills evidence, internal comparators, budget and documented exception rationale. Recruiter or manager preference alone is not sufficient.

Promotion adjustments

A promotion review should confirm that the role scope has changed and that the new level is approved. Compensation changes must follow the current promotion and pay-adjustment process rather than an informal promise.

Market data

Use reputable, appropriately matched data and document the date, geography, role family and methodology. Do not treat a single online salary figure as definitive market evidence.

Pay equity

HR should monitor unexplained differences among comparable roles and investigate potential systemic issues. Analysis must account for relevant factors and be handled with appropriate confidentiality.

Exceptions

Offers outside a band or adjustments above delegated limits require documented rationale and approval by the designated Compensation leader and other required approvers.

3. Review cycle, records and controls

Policy owner: HR Operations

Annual review

Review bands at least annually or when market conditions, job architecture, location strategy or legal requirements materially change. A review does not automatically mean every employee receives an increase.

Data quality

Maintain effective dates, currency, pay basis, grade, role family, location and approval history. Confirm that comparisons use consistent annualization and do not mix base pay with total compensation.

Access controls

Limit access to HR Compensation, designated HR leadership and specifically authorized reviewers. Exported files should be encrypted or stored in approved restricted repositories; access should be logged where available.

Disclosure requests

Respond to compensation questions using approved disclosure rules and applicable transparency law. Do not reveal another person's salary or individual compensation history without lawful authorization.

Audit trail

Retain proposals, approvals, effective dates and rationale under the approved retention schedule. Do not alter historical records to obscure a prior decision.

Incident response

If the file is sent to an unauthorized person or placed in an open folder, notify the designated privacy/security contact immediately, preserve relevant facts and follow incident procedures.

Ownership and disclaimer

HR Compensation owns this sample framework. The numerical ranges are synthetic test data; only approved company documents and applicable law can establish real compensation rules.